

CONTEXT FOR ASTRA

You are my German tutor. I am Kevin, Italian, level A2-B1. My lessons are taught in English by a native German speaker (Stefanie). Today we are reviewing: **Relative clauses with relative pronouns**

Sections covered: 17. Nebensätze - 1. Relativsätze

LESSON SUMMARY

The lesson focused on forming relative clauses (Relativsätze) using relative pronouns in different cases. Kevin practiced constructing sentences describing people and situations in a building, using der/die/das/dem/den/denen as relative pronouns. The lesson covered dative and accusative cases in relative clauses, practiced verbs with prepositions (sprechen über + AKK, denken an + AKK), and reviewed conjunctions like deshalb and deswegen. Kevin demonstrated good understanding of case usage in relative constructions, particularly with prepositions requiring specific cases.

KEY VOCABULARY

- **der Lärm** — noise [A2]
- **der Klang** — sound [A2]
- **die Kirche** — church [A1]
- **entfernt** — away, distant [A2]
- **das Paar** — couple, pair [A2]
- **das Dach** — roof [A2]
- **der Stock** — floor, story [A2]
- **das Büro** — office [A1]
- **das Arbeitszimmer** — office, study [A2]
- **die Steuer** — tax [B1]
- **das Fenster** — window [A1]
- **der Junge** — boy [A1]
- **die Leute** — people [A1]
- **die Person** — person [A1]
- **das Geschenk** — gift, present [A2]
- **das Gemüse** — vegetables [A1]
- **bezahlen** — to pay [A2]
- **kaputtmachen** — to break [A2]
- **treffen** — to meet [A2]
- **feiern** — to celebrate, party [A2]
- **denken** — to think [A2]
- **überlegen** — to think over, ponder [B1]
- **erzählen** — to tell [A2]
- **besuchen** — to visit [A2]

GRAMMAR POINTS

Relative clauses with relative pronouns (Relativsätze)

→ Relative clauses provide additional information about a noun in the main sentence. The relative pronoun (der/die/das/dem/den/denen) agrees in gender and number with the noun it refers to, but its case depends on its function within the relative clause. The conjugated verb always goes to the end of the relative clause, and the clause is set off by commas.

e.g. Das Paar, das ein Problem mit dem Dach hat, wohnt im vierten Stock. (nominative - das is subject of relative clause)

e.g. Der Mann, den ich gestern getroffen habe, ist mein Lehrer. (accusative - den is direct object)

Deshalb and deswegen as causal connectors

→ Deshalb and deswegen both mean 'that's why' or 'therefore' and introduce a consequence or result. They are conjunctive adverbs (Konjunkionaladverbien) that start a new main clause and require inversion, with the verb immediately following them in position 2. They must be preceded by a period or semicolon, never a comma.

e.g. Ich bin krank. Deshalb bleibe ich zu Hause. (I'm sick. Therefore I'm staying home.)

e.g. Die Kirche ist 500 Meter entfernt. Deswegen höre ich den Lärm nicht. (The church is 500 meters away. That's why I don't hear the noise.)

Verbs with prepositions: sprechen über + AKK, denken an + AKK

→ Many German verbs require specific prepositions that form fixed combinations. These prepositional verbs must be learned together as units, and the preposition determines the case of the following object. 'Sprechen über' (to talk about) requires accusative, and 'denken an' (to think about/of) also requires accusative. The preposition often loses its original meaning in these fixed combinations.

e.g. Wo wohnt der Hund, über den ich gesprochen habe? (Where lives the dog I spoke about? - über + accusative)

e.g. Wo wohnt die Person, an die ich gestern gedacht habe? (Where lives the person I thought of yesterday? - an + accusative)

Relative pronouns with prepositions in relative clauses

→ When a relative clause contains a verb with a required preposition or expresses a prepositional relationship, the preposition must appear directly before the relative pronoun at the beginning of the relative clause. The preposition determines the case of the relative pronoun. For plural dative, the special form 'denen' (not 'den') must be used.

e.g. Es gibt ein Büro, in dem man Steuern bezahlen kann. (There's an office in which one can pay taxes - in + dative)

e.g. Wo wohnen die Leute, mit denen ich gestern gefeiert habe? (Where do the people live with whom I celebrated yesterday? - mit + dative plural = denen)

Relativsatz position and word order flexibility

→ A relative clause can be positioned either in the middle of a sentence (as an insertion immediately after its antecedent) or at the end. When positioned in the middle, the main clause must continue after the relative clause ends. The relative clause always immediately follows the noun it describes. Both positions are grammatically correct, though middle positioning requires careful attention to continuing the main clause properly.

e.g. Das Paar, das ein Problem mit dem Dach hat, wohnt im vierten Stock. (Relative clause in middle, between subject and verb)

e.g. Im vierten Stock wohnt das Paar, das ein Problem mit dem Dach hat. (Relative clause at end)

USEFUL PHRASES / REDEMittel

- **Was soll ich noch sagen?** — What else should I say? (*asking for more information or topics to discuss*)
- **Das hab ich noch nie gesehen** — I have never seen that (*spoken language with subject pronoun dropped*)
- **Das mach ich gern** — I'd be happy to do that (*spoken language with subject pronoun dropped*)
- **Iss endlich dein Gemüse!** — Finally eat your vegetables! (*imperative command, informal*)
- **Sei ruhig!** — Be quiet! (*imperative command from sein*)

EXERCISES TO GENERATE

1. FILL IN THE BLANK (5 sentences)

Use the key vocabulary above. Leave one word blank per sentence. Show the answer after a separator.

2. TRANSLATION DE → EN (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

3. TRANSLATION EN → DE (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

4. DIALOGUE COMPLETION (2 short dialogues, 3-4 lines)

Leave one or two lines blank. Context: everyday situations using today's grammar (Relative clauses with relative pronouns (Relativsätze)).

5. FREE WRITING PROMPT

Ask me to write 3-5 sentences in German using at least 5 words from today's vocabulary.

6. GRAMMAR DRILL (5 sentences)

Focus on: Relative clauses with relative pronouns (Relativsätze). Show sentences with errors for me to correct.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Correct all my answers immediately with explanation in English
- Note recurring mistakes throughout the session
- Use only A2-B1 vocabulary unless I ask for more
- If I write something correct but unnatural, suggest a more native alternative
- Use 'die KI' not 'AI' when referring to artificial intelligence